

SEED ROUND · AUGUST 2026

Grainline

Specialty grain, farm to brewhouse, without the broker.

Specialty grain moves by phone call

- Craft brewers, distillers and artisan bakeries want heritage and identity-preserved grain. Farms grow it but sell through brokers who take 18 to 25% and strip the farm's name off the bag.
- Buyers cannot see what is in storage, at what spec, or when it can ship.
- Farms carry the price risk for a crop they planted on a handshake.

What Grainline does

- Listings with lab specs (protein, falling number, moisture) uploaded from the farm's own test results.
- Forward contracts: buyers commit to acreage before planting, farms get a deposit.
- Freight arranged through regional haulers; Grainline holds payment in escrow until delivery is accepted.

Traction

\$2.9M

GMV, TRAILING 12 MONTHS

\$214k

NET REVENUE, TRAILING 12 MONTHS

96

FARMS LISTED

410

BUYER ACCOUNTS

Take rate 7.4% on spot sales and 5% on forward contracts. Repeat purchase rate among buyers who have bought twice: 71%.

Business model

- Transaction fee on every sale, paid by the buyer.
- Forward-contract deposit financing: 1.5% per month on advanced deposits (pilot).
- Freight margin of 8% on arranged shipments.
- Average order \$4,100.
- Gross margin 81% on marketplace fees.
- Payment terms settled through escrow; no credit exposure to date.

Market

- US craft brewing, distilling and artisan baking buy about \$1.9B of grain and malt a year.
- Roughly 30% is specialty or identity-preserved, the segment that moves through brokers today: \$570M.
- We also see early demand from pet-food and snack brands that market single-origin ingredients.

Competition

	Grainline	Regional brokers	Mercaris	Direct farm sales
Spec data visible before purchase	Yes	No	Partly	Sometimes
Forward contracts with deposit	Yes	Rarely	No	Handshake
Freight and escrow handled	Yes	Freight only	No	No
Fee to buyer	5 to 7.4%	18 to 25%	Subscription	0

Team

- Ellis Ward, CEO. Grain buyer for a 40-location bakery group; ran \$60M of annual purchasing.
- June Okafor, COO. Fourth-generation farmer; ran grain operations for a 9,000-acre family farm.
- Tomas Reyes, CTO. Built logistics and payments at Flexport.
- Team of 8, based in Minneapolis.

The raise

- Raising \$2.5M seed.
- Use of funds: buyer-side sales in the Northeast and Pacific Northwest, lab partnerships in three states, deposit-financing facility.
- Goal: \$12M GMV and 300 farms by harvest 2027.

Thank you

ellis@grainline.co · grainline.co